

The Santa Barbara Mariachi Festival

Digital Concept, Research & Strategy Dossier — Internal Exploration

Prepared as an unsolicited concept study · Not authorized by, affiliated with, or endorsed by the Santa Barbara Mariachi Festival, Inc.

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0. How to read this document

This is an **internal, exploratory concept study**. It was produced without contacting the organization, without any engagement or authorization, and without touching the live website. Nothing here should be published, sent to the organization as if it were sanctioned work, or represented as an official Santa Barbara Mariachi Festival product. Every recommendation is a proposal to be validated with the client before any production begins.

Because accuracy is the whole point of a concept like this, every material claim is tagged:

- **[FACT]** — Verified against a credible public source, cited in the source list.
- **[INFERENCE]** — A reasonable conclusion drawn from evidence, but not directly stated by a source.
- **[REC]** — A recommendation or design opinion of this study, not a fact about the org.
- **[UNKNOWN]** — Not determinable from public sources; requires client confirmation before use.

The single most consequential research finding is in the box below. Read it first, because it overturns a premise in the original brief.

⚠ Lineup correction — read before anything else

The brief assumed a 2026 lineup of **Majo Aguilar, Joss Favela, and Mariachi Los Camperos**. Research does not support that.

- **[FACT]** The only performer named on any official ticketing/venue source (AXS event #1425277) is **Mariachi Los Camperos** (“...and more”).
- **[FACT]** The festival’s **own homepage** names **Mariachi Vargas de Tecalitlán** (“El Son De La Negra / Guadalajara”) in its 2026 messaging.
- **[FACT]** The Santa Barbara Bowl event page states the **artist lineup “will be announced soon.”**

- **[INFERENCE] Majo Aguilar and Joss Favela** almost certainly belong to a **different event** — “Viva El Mariachi!” at **Cal Expo, Sacramento** — not the Santa Barbara Bowl. No official Santa Barbara source names them.

Consequence: This concept is built on verified facts and is deliberately structured so the lineup is a *managed variable*, not a hard-coded assumption. Do not design, advertise, or price around Majo Aguilar / Joss Favela until the client confirms. The safest sourced statement today is: *“Featuring Mariachi Los Camperos, Mariachi Vargas de Tecalitlán, and more — full lineup announced soon.”* Confirm even that with the organization.

1. Executive summary

The Santa Barbara Mariachi Festival is a **29-year-old 501(c)(3) cultural institution** whose flagship event — one night at the Santa Barbara Bowl on the Saturday of Old Spanish Days Fiesta — funds **college scholarships for local Latino students**. Its digital presence badly undersells all three of those truths. The current website is a dated Squarespace template with drifting bilingual content, a fragile single-point ticket path routed through an untrustworthy-looking link shortener, generic SEO, and no emotional or historical storytelling despite the organization sitting on a **29-year photographic archive**, a **\$1M+ scholarship legacy**, and a roster of **named student recipients bound for Stanford, Brown, and UCLA**.

The opportunity is not to “modernize the template.” It is to build the first mariachi-festival website that treats the form with the seriousness museums give their collections and premier amphitheaters give their programming — a **cinematic, bilingual, scholarship-forward campaign platform** that (a) sells tickets across a real six-tier seat map without cheapening the premium seats, and (b) makes the scholarship mission the emotional engine rather than a footer note.

The core strategic recommendation is a hybrid positioning (Phase 4, option E), led by institution and mission, activated by the event: A 29-year Santa Barbara tradition where a night of world-class mariachi sends local kids to college. This is defensible against every fact we verified, it is the one story no competing concert can copy, and it strengthens — rather than competes with — ticket conversion.

The rest of this dossier delivers, in order: the full research record and its sources; a page-by-page audit of the current site; competitive patterns worth borrowing; the positioning and voice; fifteen audience journeys; a from-first-principles sitemap; a section-by-section homepage blueprint; page blueprints; a conversion and ticketing system tuned to real published prices; a scholarship storytelling system; visual, motion, technical, CMS, analytics, SEO, accessibility, and bilingual plans; an asset inventory and shot list; a risk register; and an implementation roadmap. It closes with a clearly-labeled internal homepage prototype.

2. Research report (Phases 1–3)

2.1 The event (2026)

- **[FACT]** **29th Annual Santa Barbara Mariachi Festival, Saturday, August 8, 2026.** Gates/doors **4:00 PM**, show **5:00 PM**. The organization’s own calendar lists the event window as **5:00–10:00 PM** (the 10:00 PM end time is the organizer’s figure; the Bowl and AXS do not publish a hard end time). (*Sources: festival calendar; Santa Barbara Bowl event page; AXS listing.*)
- **[FACT]** A private, ticketed **VIP Sponsor Party** is held **Friday, August 7, 2026, 5:00–9:00 PM** for sponsors and scholarship recipients — not sold to the public. (*Festival calendar.*)
- **[FACT]** The festival falls on **Fiesta Saturday** of Old Spanish Days, Santa Barbara’s marquee cultural week. (*Noozhawk; festival history.*)
- **[FACT]** New for 2026: the organization has introduced its **first-ever Vocal Competition**, whose winner earns the chance to **open the August 8 festival**, tied to a **Winter Show**. (*Festival social; Lobero Theatre listing.*)

2.2 Venue

- **[FACT]** **Santa Barbara Bowl**, an outdoor amphitheater at **1122 N. Milpas Street, Santa Barbara, CA 93103**; box office 805-962-7411; **seated capacity 4,562**. It is a terraced, sandstone-walled hillside venue widely described as one of the most beautiful open-air venues on the West Coast. (*AXS; Wikipedia; Santa Barbara Independent.*)
- **[INFERENCE]** Because the Bowl is steeply terraced, **sightlines and comfort genuinely differ by tier** — which makes seat-view media unusually valuable here (see Ticketing, \$9).

2.3 Tickets & pricing

- **[FACT]** Ticketing runs through **AXS** (the Bowl’s official provider); event **#1425277**. (*AXS; Bowl.*)
- **[FACT]** Published price grid (Santa Barbara Bowl event page; stated as box-office prices — AXS online prices may add fees / dynamic “AXS Premium” seats):

Tier (as published)

General Admission — Floor

Preferred

Mid

—

—

ADA

- **[FACT]** Purchase rules: **limit 10 per customer**, mobile/paperless entry, transfer delay, all-ages event. (*Bowl; AXS.*)

- [UNKNOWN] Exact original on-sale date, any presale codes, and whether “AXS Premium” dynamic seats sit above \$199. The listing appears to have gone live around **mid-May 2026** ([INFERENCE] from asset upload/modified dates), but no stated on-sale date was found.
- [INFERENCE] Note the price *inversion* relative to intuition: **Sections A–C (\$79) are the far, backless benches**, while **GA Floor (\$199)** and **Preferred J–O (\$179)** are the premium product. Section letters do **not** communicate value; this is a conversion problem to solve (see §9).

2.4 The organization

- [FACT] Legal entity **Santa Barbara Mariachi Festival, Inc.**; **501(c)(3)** public charity; **tax-exempt since June 1998**; **EIN 77-0472982**; NTEE Arts/Culture/Music. **P.O. Box 153, Santa Barbara, CA 93102.** (*ProPublica Nonprofit Explorer*; site footer.)
- [FACT] **Bylaws created 1995; first festival during Fiesta week 1996.** Co-founded by **Salud Carbajal, Al Pizano (now deceased), and Miguel Avila.** The **Greater Santa Barbara Hispanic Chamber of Commerce** has supported it since year one. (*About page*; *Noozhawk*; *KEYT*.)
- [FACT] **All-volunteer board** (all officers report \$0 compensation on Form 990). Current officers per the English board page: **Miguel Martinez (President), Perla Navarro Lewis (VP), Erika Aldaz (Treasurer), Liz Ruiz (Secretary)**, plus seven members. (*Board page*; *ProPublica*.)
- [FACT] Selected 990 financials (*ProPublica*, EIN 77-0472982): FY2019 rev **\$513,775**; FY2022 rev **\$513,186**; FY2023 rev **\$397,057**; **FY2024 rev \$286,857 / exp \$449,412** (a deficit year, net assets **\$88,906**). COVID years (FY2020–21) were minimal. (*ProPublica*.)
- [INFERENCE] The FY2024 deficit and revenue dip suggest **ticket revenue is under real pressure** — which is consistent with the brief’s stated concern about remaining seat inventory and makes a genuinely better conversion system materially valuable, not cosmetic.

2.5 The scholarship mission

- [FACT] Mission: “...dedicated to promoting and preserving the tradition of mariachi music and directing its revenues to provide scholarships that help further the education of Latino students.” Board framing adds: “...promote higher education in the Latinx community of the Central Coast.” (*About*; *Board page*.)
- [FACT] Scholarships are **administered by the Scholarship Foundation of Santa Barbara** (sbscholarship.org); recipients and families are honored at a reception and receive festival tickets. (*Scholarships page*; *Noozhawk*.)
- [FACT] The org states “**\$1,000,000 in scholarships**” awarded to date; *Noozhawk* (2024) corroborates “more than \$1 million.” *Noozhawk* also reports individual awards **ranging \$2,500–\$5,000 and \$75,000 granted in 2024.** (*Scholarships page*; *Noozhawk*.)
- [FACT] The Spanish “Becas” page lists **26 named 2024 recipients** with their colleges — **Stanford, Brown, UCLA, Cal Poly SLO, UC Santa Barbara, Santa Clara, Pitzer,**

Westmont, and more. The Santa Barbara Independent reported **15 students honored in 2025**. (*Becas page; Independent.*)

- **[UNKNOWN]** A single reconciled cumulative figure. The org site says **\$1,000,000**; the Independent (2025) cited **“more than \$650,000.”** These conflict; **do not present one settled number** without client confirmation. The safe public phrasing is *“more than \$1 million awarded since 1996”* only if the client stands behind it; otherwise *“decades of scholarships for local Latino students.”*
- **[UNKNOWN]** Exact per-year totals beyond 2024’s \$75,000 (these live in Schedule I of the full 990s and were not extracted).
- **[INFERENCE + REC]** The organization **funds college scholarships**; there is **no public evidence it runs youth/school mariachi instruction**. Do **not** claim it operates music-education programs. If a “future musicians” story is desired, it must be sourced to partner programs, with permission.

2.6 Media, assets & social

- **[FACT]** Recurring, warm local press: **Santa Barbara Independent** (annual festival reviews + scholarship coverage), **KEYT/NewsChannel 3-12** (which also runs **Telemundo Central Coast**), and **Noozhawk**. Framing is consistently culture-and-scholarships, not attendance metrics. (*Independent; KEYT; Noozhawk.*)
- **[FACT]** The site hosts a **2025 festival photo gallery (~70–90 images)**; the Independent credits **RG Photography** on 2025 festival images. Noozhawk’s Fiesta images are credited **Fritz Olenberger / Old Spanish Days**. (*Site; Independent; Noozhawk.*)
- **[FACT]** Active on **Facebook** (/SBMariachiFestival) and **Instagram** (@sbmariachifest) with bilingual captions and lineup/scholarship content. **No official YouTube or TikTok** channel found; existing video lives on third-party news channels. (*FB; IG; YouTube.*)
- **[UNKNOWN / LOW-CONFIDENCE]** IG following (~2,155) came only from search snippets and was **not** verified on the live page. Post cadence and engagement need a manual logged-in pass.
- **[UNKNOWN]** Spanish-language broadcast coverage is **[INFERENCE]** likely (via Telemundo Central Coast) but no specific segment was surfaced.

2.7 Cultural significance & draw

- **[FACT]** Credible sources call it *“a nearly 30-year Santa Barbara Fiesta tradition,” “the heart and soul of Santa Barbara’s Fiesta,”* and a fixture at *“one of the most breathtaking open-air venues on the West Coast.”* Performers are drawn nationally and from Mexico. (*Noozhawk; Independent.*)
- **[UNKNOWN — do not claim]** No credible source calls it the **“largest,” “oldest,” or “longest-running”** mariachi festival anywhere. **Do not use those claims**. No public attendance figures or attendee-origin data exist; **do not invent attendance or “sold-out” history**.
- **[INFERENCE]** Given Fiesta-week timing, scholarship-recipient/family base, and a regional Latino community, the draw is primarily **local Santa Barbara + Central**

Coast + Southern California, with the beneficiary community distinctly local. State this as inference, not fact.

3. Source list (Deliverable 2)

Primary / official:

- Festival website (Squarespace), all pages:
<https://www.thesantabarbaramariachifestival.org/> and its subpages /projects, /board, /espanol, /our-sponsors, /sponsors, /calendar, /new-page-2, /new-page-1, /contact, and Spanish /projects-1, /board-1, /espanol-2, /our-sponsors-copy, /become-a-sponsor-copy, /contact-1, /eventos
- Santa Barbara Bowl 2026 event page: <https://sbbowl.com/concerts/santa-barbara-mariachi-festival-2026-2026-08-08/>
- AXS listing, event #1425277: <https://www.axs.com/events/1425277/29th-santa-barbara-mariachi-festival-tickets>
- ProPublica Nonprofit Explorer (EIN 77-0472982):
<https://projects.propublica.org/nonprofits/organizations/770472982>
- Scholarship Foundation of Santa Barbara: <https://www.sbscholarship.org/>
- Lobero Theatre (Winter Show / Vocal Competition listing):
<https://www.lobero.org/events/santa-barbara-mariachi-festival-winter-show-vocal-competition/>

Press:

- Santa Barbara Independent — 28th Annual review (RG Photography credit):
<https://www.independent.com/2025/08/06/celebrating-mexican-culture-at-28th-annual-santa-barbara-mariachi-festival/>
- Santa Barbara Independent — 2025 scholarships (15 students):
<https://www.independent.com/2025/05/29/15-students-honored-with-mariachi-festival-scholarships/>
- Santa Barbara Independent — 25th anniversary:
<https://www.independent.com/2022/07/28/santa-barbara-mariachi-festival-x-25/>
- Noozhawk — Fiesta / \$1M / \$75K / 1996 founding:
<https://www.noozhawk.com/mariachis-the-heart-and-soul-of-santa-barbaras-fiesta-celebration/>
- KEYT — “fills the Bowl” (2024):
<https://keyt.com/news/santa-barbara-s-county/2024/08/03/mariachi-festival-fills-santa-barbara-bowl/>
- KEYT — “27 years of music and scholarships” (2024): <https://keyt.com/news/santa-barbara-s-county/2024/08/02/the-santa-barbara-mariachi-festival-celebrates-27-years-of-music-and-scholarships/>

Venue / reference:

- Santa Barbara Bowl (Wikipedia, capacity/history): https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Santa_Barbara_Bowl
- Contrasting Majo Aguilar + Joss Favela event (Cal Expo, Sacramento — NOT Santa Barbara): <https://sacramento.downtowngrid.com/events/viva-el-mariachi-majo-aguilar-and-joss-favela-cal-expo/>

Social:

- Facebook: <https://www.facebook.com/SBMariachiFestival/> · Instagram: <https://www.instagram.com/sbmariachifest/>
- Third-party festival video (examples): <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Alwq113hQvQ> · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eoS-qOby84o>

Competitive/pattern exemplars are cited inline in §6 (Hollywood Bowl, Newport Folk, Smithsonian NMAL/NMMA, Coachella, USAGov en Español, et al.).

4. Verified-facts table (Deliverable 3)

#	Fact	Value	Confidence	Source
1	Edition	29th Annual	FACT	Bowl/AXS/site
2	Date	Sat, Aug 8, 2026	FACT	Bowl/AXS/ calendar
3	Gates / Show	4:00 PM / 5:00 PM	FACT	Bowl/AXS
4	End time	~ 10:00 PM (organizer-listed)	FACT (organizer)	Festival calendar
5	Venue	Santa Barbara Bowl, 1122 N. Milpas St.	FACT	AXS
6	Capacity	4,562 seated	FACT	Wikipedia
7	Ticketing	AXS, event #1425277	FACT	AXS/Bowl
8	Prices	\$79 / \$109 / \$149 / \$179 / \$199; ADA \$79	FACT (box-office)	Bowl
9	Confirmed act	Mariachi Los Camperos (“... and more”)	FACT	AXS
10	Site-stated headliner	Mariachi Vargas de Tecalitlán	FACT (org claim)	Festival homepage
11	Majo Aguilar / Joss Favela in	Not supported; likely	INFERENCE	Cal Expo listing

	SB	Sacramento event		
12	Founded	Bylaws 1995; first festival 1996	FACT	About/ Noozhawk
13	Co-founders	Salud Carbajal, Al Pizano (dec.), Miguel Avila	FACT	About/ Noozhawk/ KEYT
14	Status	501(c)(3), EIN 77-0472982, exempt since 1998	FACT	ProPublica
15	Board	All-volunteer; Pres. Miguel Martinez (EN page)	FACT	Board/ ProPublica
16	Scholarship admin	Scholarship Foundation of Santa Barbara	FACT	Scholarships page
17	Cumulative scholarships	“\$1,000,000” (org) vs “\$650,000+” (Independent 2025)	CONFLICT	Site/ Independent
18	Per-award / annual	\$2,500–\$5,000; \$75,000 in 2024	FACT (journalist)	Noozhawk
19	2024 named recipients	26 listed w/ colleges	FACT	Becas page
20	2025 recipients	15 students honored	FACT	Independent
21	FY2024 financials	Rev \$286,857 / Exp \$449,412	FACT	ProPublica
22	Backer since year one	Greater SB Hispanic Chamber of Commerce	FACT	Noozhawk
23	2025 photographer	RG Photography	FACT	Independent
24	Social	FB + IG active; no official YouTube/TikTo	FACT	FB/IG

		k		
25	"Oldest/largest" claim	Unsupported — do not use	UNKNOWN	—

5. Unknowns requiring client confirmation (Deliverable 4)

1. **Final 2026 lineup** and billing order (headliner vs. support vs. Vocal Competition opener). *Blocks: hero copy, Artists page, campaign LPs, ticket messaging.*
2. **Reconciled cumulative scholarship total** (\$1M vs \$650K+). *Blocks: hero stat, scholarship page, donor copy.*
3. **Per-year scholarship dollars & recipient counts** (2019–2025) for a credible impact timeline.
4. **Photo/video rights** — RG Photography license terms; permission for any archival images; recipient image/consent releases.
5. **On-sale/presale mechanics** and whether AXS is running dynamic "Premium" pricing above \$199.
6. **Whether the org wants a donations/giving flow** on-site (currently none) and the payment processor for it.
7. **Live social metrics** (IG/FB followers, cadence, engagement) via a logged-in audit.
8. **Governance capacity** — who, internally, would maintain a CMS (informs the tech recommendation).
9. **Spanish voice preference** — *tú* vs *usted*, regional Mexican Spanish, and who can author/approve Spanish copy.
10. **Sponsor package details** (tiers, benefits, pricing) currently locked inside screenshot images.

6-AUDIT. Current website audit (Deliverable 5 / Phase 2)

The current site is a bilingual **Squarespace** build: a 10-item English top nav plus a separate 7-item "Espanol" sub-nav. Sixteen of seventeen pages carry real content; one is a stub. The problems are not "it looks old" — they are **specific, compounding failures of clarity, trust, conversion, and bilingual parity**. Each major weakness below follows the format: *what's happening* → *why it's a problem* → *opportunity lost* → *fix* → *type*.

6.1 First impression & hero

What's happening. The homepage opens on a portrait image whose filename is "*Cris Omar Wedding-Family Formals-0123.jpg*" — apparently a wedding photo — with the headline "*Celebrating 29 Years of a Santa Barbara Tradition,*" a Spanish purchase heading, and a **raw AXS URL pasted as visible body text**. **Why it's a problem.** The first frame communicates neither *what the event is*, *when it is*, nor *why it matters*; a wedding image reads as a placeholder, and an exposed tracking URL reads as broken. **Opportunity lost.** The most emotionally rich subject imaginable — a mariachi in full traje on the Bowl stage at dusk —

is replaced by a stock-feeling portrait; the 29-year story and the scholarship mission are invisible above the fold. **Fix.** A cinematic, poster-backed hero (see §7) with one line of type, the date/venue, and a single ticket CTA. **Type:** strategic + visual + conversion.

6.2 Event clarity

What's happening. The date (Aug 8), gates/show times, and venue are **not stated on the homepage**; they live only on the Calendar page, which itself has no ticket link. **Why it's a problem.** A first-time visitor cannot answer “when and where” without hunting.

Opportunity lost. Every festival page should answer who/what/when/where/why in the first screen; the current site forces work. **Fix.** Persistent event “dateline” (29th Annual · Sat Aug 8, 2026 · Santa Barbara Bowl · Gates 4 / Show 5) in the hero and a sticky element.

Type: conversion + content.

6.3 Artist presentation

What's happening. Artists appear as two lines of plain text near the ticket link (“El Son De La Negra / Guadalajara,” “Mariachi Vargas de Tecalitlán”), with no images, bios, or links.

Why it's a problem. Artists are the primary purchase driver and the primary paid-search/paid-social target; text lines cannot be shared, ranked, or retargeted. **Opportunity lost.** No artist discovery, no Spotify/YouTube embeds, no artist→ticket path. **Fix.** An Artists module with editorial portraits, short bios, listen links, and a “Get tickets” CTA per artist (see §8, §11). **Type:** conversion + content + visual.

6.4 Ticket CTA & conversion path

What's happening. The **only** purchase entry point sits on the homepage as a Spanish heading — “*Compra tus entradas para 2026 aquí*” — linking to a **shorturl.at redirect**, alongside a second raw AXS URL. The Calendar/Events page has **no ticket link at all**, and the Spanish nav has **no homepage and no ticket path**. **Why it's a problem.** (1) A link shortener on a payment path erodes trust and can trip spam filters; (2) the primary CTA is in Spanish on the English page and absent from the page where researchers expect to buy; (3) Spanish-speaking users — a core audience — have **no route to purchase**.

Opportunity lost. This is the highest-value fix in the entire audit: the conversion path is simultaneously fragile, mis-placed, and monolingual. **Fix.** Replace with a branded, tracked ticket route (direct AXS deep link with UTMs), a sticky mobile CTA, ticket CTAs on every relevant page, and a full Spanish conversion path. **Type:** conversion + technical + trust.

6.5 Information hierarchy & navigation

What's happening. Ten top-nav items of unequal importance (“Mariachi Recommendations” sits beside “Scholarships”); a stub page (/new-page-1) has no content; “Upcoming Events” lists a long tail of **past** events (back to 2023) with recycled slugs. **Why it's a problem.** Flat, undifferentiated navigation buries the two things that matter (tickets, scholarships) and surfaces noise. **Opportunity lost.** No sense of priority; nothing signals “buy” or “the mission.” **Fix.** A purpose-built IA (see §6-IA) with a primary ticket action, a

mission section, and archived past events filtered out of “upcoming.” **Type:** strategic + content.

6.6 Bilingual UX & English/Spanish parity

What’s happening. The Spanish experience is a **drifting, partial mirror**: the Spanish “Nuestra Historia” still says “27 años” while English says “29 years”; the Spanish **Board page shows a different, outdated leadership hierarchy** (Avila as President) than the English page (Martinez as President) — a factual contradiction, not just translation lag; the Spanish “Eventos” page lists only **2025** events and omits the 2026 festival entirely; “Se Patrocinador” still advertises the **2025** sponsorship cycle; a César Chávez quote is left untranslated; and the Spanish nav lacks Home, Photos, and any ticket path. **Why it’s a problem.** For a heavily Spanish-speaking community, the Spanish site is stale, self-contradicting, and cannot sell a ticket. **Opportunity lost.** Spanish should be a **first-class, authored experience**, not a decaying copy. **Fix.** A parallel /es/ architecture with transcreated (not machine-translated) copy, full parity including tickets, a persistent context-aware “Español” toggle, and a single source of truth for facts like the board (see §22). **Type:** strategic + content + trust.

6.7 Trust signals

What’s happening. Stale “© 2015” footers on two pages; “27th/28th Anniversary Sponsor” copy on Contact pages; a **transposed contact email** (mailto points to sbmariachifestival@gmail.com while the site uses mariachifestivalsb@gmail.com) that may bounce; sponsorship tiers locked inside screenshots; the ticket shortener. **Why it’s a problem.** Each is a small credibility leak; together they signal neglect for a 29-year institution handling scholarship money. **Opportunity lost.** Trust is the nonprofit’s core asset and the thing that converts both ticket-buyers and donors. **Fix.** Correct all stale copy; fix the email; display 501(c)(3) status, EIN, Candid/Charity Navigator badges (if earned), and the scholarship partner near asks. **Type:** trust + content.

6.8 Typography, color, photography, motion

What’s happening. Default Squarespace type; no deliberate color system; the richest asset (a 29-year photo archive + a credited 2025 set) is confined to one gallery page with **filename alt text** (“5S1A1245.jpg”); no motion or narrative. **Why it’s a problem.** Nothing about the craft signals a premium cultural institution; the photography — the emotional core — is buried and inaccessible. **Opportunity lost.** A distinctive, non-cliché visual system and a graded archive could carry the whole brand (see §10). **Fix.** The visual and motion systems in §10–11, applied to real, rights-cleared photography with proper alt text. **Type:** visual + content + accessibility.

6.9 Scholarship & historical storytelling

What’s happening. The scholarship page states a dollar figure and shows reception photo galleries; the 26 named 2024 recipients live only on a **Spanish** page; there is no narrative, no recipient voice, no history beyond a paragraph. **Why it’s a problem.** The single most

differentiating, emotionally powerful, donor-relevant asset the org owns is presented as an administrative note. **Opportunity lost.** Recipient stories bound for Stanford/Brown/UCLA, a 29-year arc, and a clear ticket→scholarship causal line are the reasons to care — and they're absent. **Fix.** The scholarship storytelling system in §12 and a Legacy/History narrative in §11. **Type:** strategic + content + emotional.

6.10 Sponsors & footer

What's happening. ~30 sponsor logos as **screenshots** ("Screenshot 2024-08-04..."), some unlinked, no tier structure; "Become a Sponsor" has no form, PDF, or CTA — the package is a screenshot; footer repeats the address but little else. **Why it's a problem.** Sponsors get no real recognition and prospects get no way to act; poor logo assets hurt SEO and polish. **Opportunity lost.** Sponsor value and a self-serve sponsorship funnel. **Fix.** A tiered sponsor wall with clean SVG logos and a real "Become a Sponsor" flow (downloadable deck + inquiry form). **Type:** conversion + content + visual.

6.11 Accessibility

What's happening. Alt text is largely filenames; text baked into screenshot images (sponsorship tiers, sponsor logos) is unreadable by screen readers and untranslatable; contrast/keyboard behavior unverified; no evidence of skip links or reduced-motion handling. **Why it's a problem.** Excludes disabled users, violates WCAG expectations for a public nonprofit, and (with image-baked text) breaks both accessibility and bilingual delivery. **Opportunity lost.** An inclusive experience for an all-ages, multigenerational, ADA-seating-selling event. **Fix.** The accessibility plan in §21 (WCAG 2.1 AA target). **Type:** technical + content.

6.12 Performance, SEO, analytics & campaign readiness

What's happening. Generic slugs (/new-page-1, /new-page-2, /projects, /espanol used for an English page); missing meta descriptions on ~9 of 17 pages; **http** canonical; screenshot images inflating weight; GTM is present (good) but there's no evident event/conversion tracking or pixel strategy tied to the (shortened, untracked) ticket link. **Why it's a problem.** The site is hard to find, hard to share correctly (broken OG previews in each language), and **cannot measure or retarget** a paid campaign — critical if inventory must move. **Opportunity lost.** Organic discovery, correct social share cards, and a measurable paid funnel. **Fix.** The SEO (\$20) and analytics (\$19) plans: clean slugs, per-language metadata + hreflang, event schema, a real conversion event on ticket-outbound clicks, and Meta/Google pixels with consent. **Type:** technical + conversion.

6.13 Audit summary — priority order

1. **Fix the conversion path** (branded tracked ticket link; sticky CTA; ticket links everywhere; Spanish purchase path). *Highest ROI.*
2. **Establish bilingual parity with a single source of truth** (kill the board contradiction, stale years, missing 2026 Spanish event).
3. **Elevate scholarship + history storytelling** (bring recipients and the 29-year arc to the surface, in both languages).

4. **Rebuild trust hygiene** (email, footers, dates, sponsor/ticket link quality; 501(c)(3) proof).
5. **Re-platform for editorial control + measurement** (clean IA/SEO, analytics, pixels, schema).

6. Competitive-pattern analysis (Phase 3)

We studied ~60 exemplars across nine categories. The goal is **transferable patterns**, never copying. The seven highest-leverage borrows:

1. **Structural twin — Hollywood Bowl.** A nonprofit outdoor amphitheater's single-event "program page" (editorial hook → lineup/program → mission-credit line → logistics with **gate time called out separately from show time** → one repeated "Buy Tickets" CTA). One beautifully built event page does the work of a whole site — and lets us skip season-subscription machinery a one-night org doesn't need. (*hollywoodbowl.com*)
2. **Operational twin — Newport Folk Festival.** A 501(c)(3) heritage event that sells on **trust**, uses a **rolling day-by-day lineup reveal**, an SMS/email "be first to know" capture, and a **face-value, anti-scalper resale waitlist** (via DICE). Borrow the conversion *honesty*, not rave mechanics. (*newportfolk.org*)
3. **The 29-year archive is an unused superpower — museum/editorial scrollytelling.** Sepia-and-grain → saturated-color progression, museum "object-label" chaptering, and a **same-stage old-to-now crossfade** turn three decades of photos into a cinematic core no competing concert can copy. (NYT "Snow Fall"; Google Arts & Culture; The Met.)
4. **Center opportunity, never pity — asset-framing.** Students as talented protagonists in their own words (QuestBridge; DonorsChoose's screening rule; Trabian Shorters). Pair a scale number with an outcome and a benchmark (Posse: "90% grad vs 59% nationally"). Donors now actively distrust poverty-porn. (*questbridge.org*; *possefoundation.org*.)
5. **Spanish must be authored, not translated — transcreation.** A first-class /es/ site with hand-localized slugs, translated metadata/alt-text, and a persistent context-aware "Español" toggle (Smithsonian NMAL; USAGov en Español). A Google Translate widget is the single worst choice. (*latino.si.edu/es*; *usa.gov/es*.)
6. **Cultural specificity through abstraction + real provenance — never props.** Abstract one meaningful mariachi form (guitarrón curve, trumpet bell, charro *botonadura*) into a durable mark; derive palette from a **real referent** (a charro suit, the Bowl's sandstone, an archival frame) — the Smithsonian NMAL / National Museum of Mexican Art model — instead of flag colors, papel picado, or agave. (*latino.si.edu*; *nationalmuseumofmexicanart.org*.)
7. **Premium reads as restraint.** One silent, muted, poster-backed film hero; one hairline "29TH ANNIVERSARY" eyebrow; one CTA (Aman; Apple TV+; A24). A staged "controlled reveal" calendar (save-the-date → headliner → full lineup → on-sale) makes each announcement a shareable moment — with the **date never hidden**.

Category-specific patterns worth adopting, and anti-patterns to avoid:

- **Ticket conversion (Coachella, Newport/DICE, Glastonbury).** Adopt: honest “prices rise on [date]” ladder; all-in pricing (2024 FTC Junk Fees Rule); per-section live status; a real face-value waitlist if a section sells out. **Avoid:** reset-on-reload countdowns, “only 3 left!” badges, manufactured scarcity queues when there is no scarcity.
- **Seat tiers & seat-view media (SeatGeek/Ticketmaster/AXS FanSight, Greek Theatre).** Adopt: **name tiers by experience, not letter** (SeatGeek found >half of buyers can’t justify a price when they don’t know what’s included); vector hover-map; **enable AXS FanSight / seed one real seat-view photo per terrace** (the sunset backdrop is itself a selling point). **Avoid:** opaque “platinum” pricing with no added benefit (Springsteen/Oasis backlash), JPG-only maps, selling a section with no view or description.
- **Scholarship nonprofits (Harmony Project LA — the closest analog, Posse, HSF, Jack Kent Cooke).** Adopt: “where are they now” alumni arcs; scale-number + outcome + benchmark; unit-based asks (“\$2,500 funds one scholarship for a year”); Candid Seal / Charity Navigator badges near the donate button (72% of donors say a badge raises likelihood of giving). **Avoid:** deficit framing, vanity metrics with no outcome, opaque finances.
- **Bilingual (Smithsonian NMAL, USAGov, NMMA).** Adopt: parallel /es/ with reciprocal hreflang, no IP auto-redirect, localized creative (two poster files), Spanish typography that renders diacritics and absorbs ~20–30% text expansion, “**Compra tus boletos.**” **Avoid:** Google Translate widget, text baked into images, a toggle that dumps you on the homepage.
- **Museum/editorial + luxury launches (Snow Fall, Apple TV+, Aman, A24).** Adopt: poster-backed silent hero, scroll-driven (never scroll-jacked) archival-to-present narrative, prefers-reduced-motion. **Avoid:** autoplay audio (doubly wrong for a *music* festival), auto-rotating carousels, spectacle that blocks first paint.

The whitespace: no mariachi festival has a genuinely well-designed website — the category is cliché. That is precisely the opening for a 29-year Santa Barbara institution to lead.

7. Strategic positioning (Phase 4)

7.1 Choosing the frame

The brief offered five framings. Evaluated against research (organizational truth), audience need, and conversion:

- **A — “Major annual live music event.”** True and drives urgency, but a concert-only frame is generic, competes on lineup (a variable we can’t yet confirm), and throws away the org’s only uncopiable assets.
- **B — “29-year Santa Barbara cultural institution.”** Deeply true and defensible; supplies gravitas and press-friendly narrative, but alone it doesn’t convert tickets.

- **C — “Scholarship nonprofit with a flagship festival.”** The literal legal and moral truth (501(c)(3); revenues → scholarships). Powerful for donors/trust, but “nonprofit-first” can read as an obligation rather than a night you want to buy into.
- **D — “Multigenerational Mexican-American cultural experience.”** The emotional reality in the seats, and the heart of the brand voice — but as the *primary* frame it’s abstract and hard to act on.
- **E — Combination.** Correct. The others are each true but partial.

7.2 Core positioning (recommendation)

A 29-year Santa Barbara tradition where one night of world-class mariachi sends local kids to college.

This is the synthesis: **institution** (B) gives authority, **event** (A) gives urgency, **scholarship** (C) gives meaning and trust, all lived as a **multigenerational cultural experience** (D). Critically, the scholarship line **reinforces** ticket conversion instead of competing with it — buying a ticket *is* the philanthropic act — which is the rare case where mission and commerce pull the same direction.

- **One-sentence brand idea:** *Every seat is a scholarship.*
- **Primary message (event/urgency):** *29 years of mariachi. One night at the Santa Barbara Bowl. — Sat, Aug 8, 2026.*
- **Secondary message (meaning/trust):** *Your night out sends a local student to college.*
- **Emotional promise:** Belonging, pride, and continuity — three generations in the same amphitheater under the oaks, the music that raised us, carried forward.
- **Functional promise:** The clearest, most trustworthy way to choose a seat, buy a ticket, and know exactly what your money does.

7.3 Audience & conversion hierarchy

- **Audience hierarchy:** (1) Ticket-ready cultural/family audience (local + regional Latino community and mariachi lovers); (2) Artist-driven fans (whoever the confirmed 2026 acts are); (3) Scholarship supporters & donors; (4) Sponsors/partners; (5) Press. Students/education communities cut across (1) and (3).
- **Conversion hierarchy:** (1) **Buy tickets**; (2) capture (email/SMS for lineup + reminders); (3) **give** to the scholarship fund; (4) sponsor inquiry; (5) share.

7.4 Tone of voice

Warm, proud, grounded, and unhurried — *the confidence of a 29-year institution, not the shouting of a startup*. Specific over generic (“the *grito* that goes up when the trumpets hit” not “unforgettable fun”). Bilingual by design. Never kitsch, never pity, never hype.

- **English copy principles:** Lead with the human truth, then the facts. Short, declarative, sensory. Numbers always paired with meaning (“\$1M+ in scholarships → hundreds of local graduates”). No manufactured urgency; urgency comes from the real date and real price ladder.

- **Spanish copy principles: Transcreated, not translated.** Authored by a native Mexican-Spanish writer, warm register, culturally fluent (leave *el grito*, *el mariachi*, song and artist names in Spanish; “**boletos**,” not “entradas”). Spanish is a **peer experience** with full ticket + scholarship parity — never a stale subset. A small bilingual glossary/style guide governs consistency.

8. Audience architecture (Phase 5)

For each audience: why they arrive → what they need first → trust → emotion → likely objection → CTA → landing path. (Where the brief named specific artists whose SB appearance is unconfirmed, journeys are written to work for **whoever the confirmed 2026 acts are**; treat “[Headliner]” as a variable.)

#	Audience	Arrives because	Needs first	Trust built by	Emotion	Likely objection	CTA	Landing path
1	Headliner fans (e.g., Los Camperos / Vargas)	Their favorite is on the bill	Confirmation + date + listen link	Official artist name, verified date	Anticipation	“Is [artist] really confirmed?”	Get tickets	Artist LP → seat map
2	Second-billing / support fans	Following a specific act	That act, elevated (not buried)	Artist page with bio + music	Discovery	“Worth it for the support act?”	Get tickets	Artist LP → tickets
3	Mariachi Los Camperos fans	Grammy-winning legacy act	Legacy framing + confirmation	Their name on AXS (verified)	Reverence	“Which night / which set?”	Get tickets	Artist LP
4	General mariachi lovers	Love the genre	The vibe + who’s playing	Photos, 29-year history	Joy	“Good seats left?”	See seats	Home → tickets
5	Mexican-American families	Annual family tradition	Family-friendly proof, times, price range	All-ages, gates 4pm, \$79 entry	Belonging	“Can I bring the kids / abuela?”	Plan your night	Home → Visit → tickets
6	Multige	Continu	The	Archive	Pride	“Is it	Explore	Legacy

	neratio nal cultural audienc e	ity, heritag e	story + the feeling	, recipie nts, press		still the real thing?"	/ tickets	→ tickets
7	Santa Barbar a locals	Fiesta- week ritual	Date within Fiesta, parking , ease	Local press, venue logistic s	Hometo wn pride	"Parkin g/ logistic s hassle"	Plan your night	Visit → tickets
8	Ventur a County	Short drive, big night	Drive time, start/e nd, value	Clear logistic s + price ladder	Occasio n	"Worth the drive?"	Tickets	Home → tickets
9	Central Coast (SLO→ Oxnard)	Region al cultural event	Date, seat value, directio ns	Venue beauty, tiers explain ed	Destina tion	"Which seats for the money?"	Compar e seats	Seat guide → tickets
10	SoCal destina tion	Make a weeken d of it	Date, hotels/ area, premiu m seats	Bowl reputat ion, GA/box	Escape	"Is it a real destina tion event?"	Tickets + plan	Home → Visit
11	Student s & educati on commu nity	Music/ educati on tie	Scholar ship + student perfor mers	Named recipie nts, colleges	Aspirati on	"Is this for me?"	Learn / tickets	Scholar ships → tickets
12	Scholar ship support ers	Want to fund student s	Impact clarity + how to give	501(c) (3), EIN, partner , outcom es	Purpos e	"Where does my money go?"	Give	Scholar ships → donate
13	Donors (major)	Conside ring a real gift	Transp arency + named impact	990, badges, alumni outcom es	Legacy	"Is this well- run?"	Give / contact	Scholar ships → Give

14	Sponso rs / corpora te	Brand + commu nity	Packag e, audienc e, benefits	Sponso r wall, reach, tiers	Commu nity standin g	“What do I get?”	Become a sponso r	Sponso rs → inquiry
15	Media	Coverin g Fiesta/f estival	Facts, dates, photos, contact s	Press kit, verified facts	—	“Where 's the info?”	Press kit	Media → assets

Cross-cutting truth: audiences 1–10 want *a great night at a fair price*; audiences 11–15 want *proof the mission is real and well-run*. The homepage must serve both in one scroll — event up top, mission woven through, both reinforcing the same act: **buy a seat**.

9-IA. Site architecture (Phase 6)

Designed from first principles; every page earns its place with a purpose, a primary audience, a primary/secondary CTA, required content, required assets, and a conversion role. Spanish (/es/...) mirrors this in full.

Top nav (primary): Tickets · Artists · Experience · Scholarships · Legacy · Visit · [Español] — with **Give** as a persistent secondary button and **Sponsors / Media / Contact** in the footer.

Page	Purpose	Primary audience	Primary CTA	Secondary CTA	Required content	Required assets	Conversion role
Home	Sell the night + the mission in one cinematic scroll	All	Get tickets	Join the list / Give	Hero, dateline, lineup, teaser, seat entry, scholarship band, legacy teaser, press, sponsors	Hero film + poster, 6–10 graded photos	Primary funnel
Tickets / Seats	Convert; make seat choice clear and honest	1–10	Buy on AXS	Seat guide	Named tiers, price ladder, seat-view	Seat map, FanSight /seat photos	Conversion core

					media, gates/show, rules, FAQ		
Artists	Discover y → desire → ticket	1–4	Get tickets	Listen	Confirmed lineup only, bios, listen/watch links, billing	Portraits, logos, embeds	Mid-funnel
Experience / Plan Your Night	Remove friction (logistics)	5–10	Get tickets	Add to calendar	Times, parking, food, what to bring, accessibility, family notes	Venue photos, map	De-risk
Scholarships	Prove the mission; move donors	11–13	Give	Meet recipients	Model, partner, cumulative impact (confirmed), recipient stories, transparency	Recipient portraits/quotes, 990/badges	Donor + trust
Legacy / History	Emotional depth; differentiation	6, 12, media	Get tickets	Explore archive	29-year narrative, year-rail, archival film treatment	Graded archive, timeline	Brand equity
Sponsors	Recognize + recruit	14	Become a sponsor	Download deck	Tiered wall, benefits,	SVG logos, deck	Revenue

	sponsors				package, inquiry form	PDF	
Visit (may merge w/ Experience)	Trip logistics	7–10	Get tickets	Directions	Address, transit/parking, area, ADA	Map, venue info	De-risk
Media / Press	Serve journalists fast	15	Download press kit	Contact	Facts sheet, approved photos, contacts	Press kit ZIP	PR
Give / Donate	Standalone giving	12–13	Donate	Monthly gift	Ask, unit-based tiers, transparency	Processor, impact copy	Donor
Contact	Reach the org	All	Email	Volunteer/board	Correct email, address, roles	—	Support
FAQ	Answer objections in-flow	5–10	Get tickets	—	Tickets, parking, ADA, kids, weather, refunds	—	De-risk

Deliberately excluded / merged: “Mariachi Recommendations” (the current stub) becomes a small, real directory only if the org will maintain it — otherwise cut. “Board” folds into Scholarships/About with a **single source of truth** to end the EN/ES contradiction. “Upcoming Events” as a mixed past/future list is replaced by a clean event model (one primary event; past editions archived under Legacy).

10. Homepage blueprint (Phase 7)

The homepage is a **cinematic campaign platform**, not a brochure. Ten sections, each with purpose, copy, visual/motion/mobile behavior, CTA, and data/asset needs. All copy is **draft** and uses only verified facts; bracketed variables [...] await client confirmation. Spanish equivalents are transcreated, not shown here for length (voice per \$7.4, spec per \$22).

Section 1 — Hero

- **Purpose:** In one frame, land the feeling and the facts; drive to tickets.
- **Copy (draft):** Eyebrow: 29TH ANNIVERSARY · SANTA BARBARA BOWL. Headline: “**29 years of mariachi. One night under the oaks.**” Dateline: Saturday, August 8, 2026 · Gates 4:00 · Show 5:00. CTA: **Get tickets** · secondary text link: *Every seat is a scholarship.*
- **Visual:** Full-bleed, **poster-still-first** hero (a mariachi mid-phrase on the Bowl stage at golden hour, or the sandstone wall glowing), video fades in over the still. Night-indigo scrim for legibility; brass-gold accent on the eyebrow rule.
- **Motion:** Still loads instantly; muted ambient loop crossfades in (~600ms); headline fades up after the image lands. No autoplay audio. Honors prefers-reduced-motion (static still + no loop).
- **Mobile:** Poster still only by default (data-friendly), tap-to-play; dateline and CTA always visible; sticky ticket bar appears on scroll.
- **CTA:** Get tickets (→ tracked AXS deep link). **Data:** confirmed date/times (FACT). **Assets:** hero film + poster still (NEEDS PRODUCTION or rights-cleared 2025 frame).

Section 2 — The dateline / at-a-glance bar

- **Purpose:** Answer who/what/when/where instantly; anchor the sticky CTA.
- **Copy:** 29th Annual Santa Barbara Mariachi Festival · Sat Aug 8, 2026 · Santa Barbara Bowl · Gates 4 / Show 5 · All ages · Tickets from \$79.
- **Visual/motion:** Thin, calm band; becomes the sticky header on scroll. **Mobile:** condenses to Aug 8 · Bowl · from \$79 · [Tickets].
- **CTA:** Get tickets. **Data:** price floor \$79 (FACT). **Assets:** none.

Section 3 — Lineup teaser (managed variable)

- **Purpose:** Sell the bill without over-committing to unconfirmed acts.
- **Copy (draft, conservative):** “**Featuring Mariachi Los Camperos, Mariachi Vargas de Tecalitlán — and more, announced soon.**” Sub: *New this year: the winner of our first-ever Vocal Competition opens the night.*
- **Visual:** Editorial artist tiles (portrait + name); a “more to be announced” tile that becomes a **rolling reveal** as acts confirm.
- **Motion:** Tiles fade/stagger on scroll; reveal state animates when a new act is added. **Mobile:** horizontal snap-scroll of tiles.
- **CTA:** Meet the artists → Artists page. **Data:** **confirmed lineup only** ([UNKNOWN] until client confirms — Los Camperos is the sole AXS-verified act; Vargas is the org’s own site claim). **Assets:** artist portraits/logos (rights to confirm).

Section 4 — Choose your seat (conversion core, on-page)

- **Purpose:** Turn “how much / which seat” into a confident click.
- **Copy:** “**From the front floor to the sunset benches, there’s a seat for every family.**” Named tiers with prices (see \$11 Tickets). Micro-line: *Prices shown are face value. Every seat funds scholarships.*

- **Visual:** Compact seat-tier cards (name, price, one-line view description, “seat-view” thumbnail); link to full seat guide + AXS.
- **Motion:** Hover/tap highlights the tier on a small Bowl map. **Mobile:** stacked cards; tap expands seat-view photo.
- **CTA (per card):** Get [tier] → tracked AXS deep link. **Data:** price grid (FACT). **Assets:** seat map, one seat-view image per terrace (FanSight or production).

Section 5 — Every seat is a scholarship (mission band)

- **Purpose:** Make the philanthropic payoff explicit at the point of intent.
- **Copy (draft):** “Since 1996, this one night has sent local students to Stanford, Brown, UCLA and beyond — [more than \$1 million] in scholarships for Santa Barbara’s Latino students.” (*Bracketed figure pending reconciliation — see \$5.*)
- **Visual:** One strong recipient portrait + a short pull-quote; a clean stat lockup.
- **Motion:** Gentle fade-up; number counts up only if reduced-motion is off. **Mobile:** portrait then stat.
- **CTA:** Meet the students → Scholarships. **Data:** cumulative figure (reconcile), colleges (FACT). **Assets:** recipient portrait + consented quote (NEEDS CLIENT ACCESS).

Section 6 — 29 years, one stage (legacy teaser)

- **Purpose:** Emotional depth + differentiation.
- **Copy:** “Three generations. One amphitheater. The music that raised us.” Sub: *From 1996 to tonight.*
- **Visual:** A **same-stage old → now** crossfade (a 1990s/2000s archival frame dissolving into a recent one); a quiet year-rail 1996 → 2026.
- **Motion:** Scroll-driven crossfade at the emotional peak; native scroll, never hijacked. **Mobile:** simplified two-image dissolve.
- **CTA:** Explore the legacy → Legacy page. **Data:** founding 1996 (FACT). **Assets:** graded archive pair (rights to confirm).

Section 7 — Plan your night (de-risk)

- **Purpose:** Remove logistics objections for families and out-of-towners.
- **Copy:** “Gates at four. Bring the family, bring a sweater, bring your grito.” Quick facts: parking, food, all-ages, ADA seating.
- **Visual:** Three or four icon+line facts; link to full Visit page.
- **Motion:** None beyond fade-in. **Mobile:** 2×2 grid.
- **CTA:** Plan your night → Visit. **Data:** gates 4/show 5, all-ages, ADA \$79 (FACT). **Assets:** venue/family photos.

Section 8 — In their words (press + community proof)

- **Purpose:** Third-party trust.
- **Copy:** Pull-quotes from the Independent / KEYT / Noozhawk (“the heart and soul of Santa Barbara’s Fiesta”).
- **Visual:** Quote cards with outlet logos (used editorially/factually).

- **CTA:** Read the coverage → Media. **Data:** real quotes (FACT, with links). **Assets:** outlet logos.

Section 9 — Our partners (sponsors)

- **Purpose:** Recognize sponsors; open the sponsor funnel.
- **Copy:** “Made possible by Santa Barbara.” Tiered logo wall.
- **Visual:** Clean SVG logos by tier. **Motion:** subtle fade. **Mobile:** 3-up grid.
- **CTA:** Become a sponsor → Sponsors. **Data:** confirmed sponsor list (FACT). **Assets:** clean logos (replace screenshots).

Section 10 — Footer / capture

- **Purpose:** Email/SMS capture, giving, trust, bilingual, contact.
- **Copy:** “Be first to know when the full lineup drops.” + Give + 501(c)(3) line + EIN + correct email + social.
- **Visual:** Calm, organized; **Español** toggle; nonprofit badges (if earned).
- **CTA (primary):** Join the list; (secondary): Give. **Data:** EIN 77-0472982, correct email (FACT). **Assets:** none.

Homepage scroll logic: feeling (1) → facts (2) → who (3) → **buy** (4) → why it matters (5) → depth (6) → de-risk (7) → proof (8, 9) → capture (10). The buy decision is reachable within the first two screens; everything after deepens conviction and gives non-ready visitors a reason to return.

11. Page-by-page blueprint (Phase 6 detail)

Tickets / Seats. *Purpose:* honest, confident seat selection. Named, experience-first tiers (draft, bilingual-ready):

Proposed name	Sections (published)	Price	One-line view description
Front Floor	GA Floor	\$199	Closest to the stage; standing/GA energy
Palco Preferente (Preferred)	J-O	\$179	Prime reserved, back-supported, balanced sightlines
Platea (Lower Reserved)	G-I	\$149	Solid reserved seats, good sightlines
Terraza (Mid Terrace)	D-F	\$109	Elevated terrace, wide views
Sunset Benches	A-C	\$79	Budget end; backless benches, the sunset backdrop
ADA / Accessible	W1, W2	\$79	Step-free,

companion seating

Each tier: seat-view thumbnail, “Get [tier]” — tracked AXS deep link, honest note (“backless,” “GA standing”). Include gates/show, 10-ticket limit, mobile-entry, all-ages, weather, FAQ. (*Names are [REC]; confirm with org and keep Spanish/English pairing.*)

Artists. Confirmed acts only; each with portrait, 2–3 sentence bio, listen/watch embed, billing note, and a ticket CTA. A “more announced soon” state for the rolling reveal. Los Camperos framed by their legacy (verify any specific accolades before printing).

Experience / Plan Your Night. Gates/parking/food/what-to-bring/ADA/family FAQ; add-to-calendar (.ics); directions. This is the “Hollywood Bowl logistics” borrow.

Scholarships. See §12 — the strategic centerpiece. Model, partner (Scholarship Foundation of SB), reconciled impact figure, recipient stories, transparency (501(c)(3), EIN, 990 link, badges), Give CTA.

Legacy / History. The 29-year scrollytelling narrative: founding (1995 bylaws / 1996 first festival), co-founders (incl. the late Al Pizano — handled with care), Fiesta-week meaning, graded archive, year-rail, and the old→now crossfade. Ends on tickets.

Sponsors. Tiered wall + benefits + downloadable package (replace screenshots) + inquiry form. **Give / Donate.** Standalone, unit-based asks, transparency. **Media.** Facts sheet (from §4), approved photos, contacts. **Contact.** Correct email, address, roles. **FAQ.** Objection-busting, cross-linked to tickets.

12-CONV. Ticketing & conversion system (Phase 8)

Principle: move real inventory **without cheapening premium seats and without fake scarcity**. Everything below assumes AXS remains the checkout (we send qualified, tracked traffic to AXS; we don’t rebuild checkout).

Ticket CTA hierarchy. One primary verb everywhere — “**Get tickets**” (ES: “**Compra tus boletos**”) — in the hero, sticky bar, per-tier cards, per-artist, and footer. Secondary actions (“Join the list,” “Give”) never compete visually with the primary.

Sticky mobile ticket CTA. Persistent bottom bar after the hero: From \$79 · Aug 8 · [Get tickets]. Collapses on scroll-up, returns on scroll-down; respects safe-area insets; always one tap to AXS.

Artist-to-ticket paths. Every artist tile/page has its own “Get tickets” with a UTM identifying the artist, so paid social per act is measurable (see below).

Seat-tier storytelling & price communication. Rename by experience (§11); show face value plainly; state honestly what each tier is (GA standing; backless benches). **All-in pricing** guidance to comply with the 2024 FTC Junk Fees Rule — if AXS adds fees at checkout, say so up front (“plus AXS fees”).

Seat-view media. Enable **AXS FanSight** and/or seed **one real seat-view photo per terrace** (the sunset backdrop sells the cheap seats honestly). Label “representative view.”

Urgency system — honest only. Permitted signals: the real date countdown (anticipation), a real **price-increase date** if the org sets one, live “**section sold out**” states pulled from reality, and a **face-value waitlist** if a tier sells out. **Prohibited:** reset-on-reload timers, “only N left” without data, “selling fast” without data, invented sold-out history.

Countdown behavior. A tasteful countdown to **Aug 8** framed as anticipation (“The oaks are waiting”), not scarcity. Switches to **day-of wayfinding** (“Gates open at 4 — here’s parking”) on event day.

Retargeting landing pages (Phase 13). Brand-consistent LPs that change only the **first message** by intent:

LP	First message (draft)	Primary audience	Notes
/lp/[headliner]	“[Confirmed act] plays the Bowl — Aug 8.”	Artist fans	One per confirmed act only
/lp/los-camperos	“Grammy-winning Mariachi Los Camperos, live at the Bowl.”	Legacy fans	Verify accolades first
/lp/familia	“Bring three generations. Gates at four.”	Families	Spanish-first variant
/lp/becas	“Your night out sends a local kid to college.”	Community/donors	Mission-led
/lp/santa-barbara	“Fiesta Saturday at the Bowl — your hometown tradition.”	Locals	Fiesta timing
/lp/asientos	“Great seats from \$79 — here’s the honest seat guide.”	Value shoppers	Seat-tier led
/lp/ultima-semana	“Final week. Aug 8 at the Bowl.”	Warm/retarget	Only if true
/lp/dia-del-evento	“Tonight at the Bowl. Gates 4, show 5.”	Day-of	Wayfinding

UTM structure. utm_source (meta|google|email|instagram|partner) · utm_medium (paid_social|cpc|email|organic_social) · utm_campaign (sbmf26) · utm_content (lp +

creative id) · utm_term (artist/tier where relevant). Applied to every AXS deep link so AXS-side conversions can be attributed by intent.

Analytics events (GA4 + Meta). view_hero, select_tier, click_get_tickets (with tier/artist params) as the **primary macro-conversion** (outbound to AXS), join_list, donate_click, sponsor_inquiry, seatview_open, lineup_reveal_view. Because checkout is off-site on AXS, the on-site conversion is the **qualified outbound ticket click**; reconcile against AXS settlement reports for true purchases.

Conversion measurement. North-star: qualified ticket clicks → (AXS-confirmed) purchases by tier and by intent LP. Secondary: list growth, donate clicks, cost-per-qualified-click by channel. This finally makes paid spend **measurable** — impossible today with a shortened, untracked link.

13-SCH. Scholarship storytelling system (Phase 9)

Treat scholarships as the **emotional engine and trust core**, not a footer note. Framing rule: **opportunity, achievement, continuity, education, future generations — never pity.**

Individual recipient stories (asset-framing). Template, student-narrated and consented: *talent/aspiration first → mariachi/community as the through-line → the goal (often first-gen college) → what the scholarship unlocked.* Example structure (illustrative, **not** a real quote): “Mariachi is how I found my voice. This fall I’ll be the first in my family at [college], studying [field].” Each story: portrait (ideally the student in traje, performing on the Bowl stage), name, hometown school, destination college, one pull-quote. **Source the 26 named 2024 recipients and 2025’s 15 honorees — with permission — as the starting library.**

Education outcomes & total impact. Pair the reconciled cumulative figure with an outcome and, if available, a benchmark (“[\$X]M since 1996 → hundreds of local graduates; many first-generation”). Only publish counts/rates the org can stand behind (see §5).

Video testimonials & portraits. Short (30–60s) recipient reflections; documentary portraits (music being made), never graduation-cap stock. Vertical cuts for social.

Alumni “where are they now.” The most underused asset: 29 years of alumni — teachers, professional musicians, first-gen grads — closing the gift→outcome loop. Start with any alumni the org can reach.

Donor trust & sponsor relevance. Near every ask: 501(c)(3), EIN 77-0472982, “administered with the Scholarship Foundation of Santa Barbara,” 990 link, and Candid/Charity Navigator badges if earned. Unit-based asks: “\$2,500–\$5,000 funds one student for a year” (per Noozhawk’s reported award range — attribute or confirm). For sponsors, connect logo → students funded.

Festival-to-scholarship connection (the causal line). State it everywhere money changes hands: **“Every seat is a scholarship.”** On the ticket page, a quiet line: “Face value;

proceeds fund scholarships for local Latino students.” This is the mechanism that makes buying a ticket feel like the gift it partly is — and it’s true.

14. Visual system (Phase 10)

Design thesis: cultural specificity through **abstraction and real provenance**, not props. The identity is derived from things that actually exist at this event — the charro suit, the instruments, the Bowl’s sandstone, the golden-hour light, the archive — so it reads as *this* festival and no other. Explicitly banned: cream/beige “luxury,” black-and-gold “premium,” red-green-white flag palettes, papel picado, agave/cactus, sombrero-and-maracas kitsch, and any decoration used merely to signal “Mexican.”

Color — from real referents.

Token	Color	Derived from	Use
--night	Deep indigo-black (#12131A-ish)	The Bowl sky at showtime	Backgrounds, scrims
--sandstone	Warm stone (#C9A66B-ish)	The Bowl’s actual sandstone walls	Surfaces, dividers
--brass	Aged brass/gold (restrained)	Trumpet bell + stage light	Accents, rules, focus
--rosa-brava	Deep rose/magenta (sparing)	A specific charro suit’s embroidery	One accent; CTAs sparingly
--bone	Off-white, warm	Shirt/paper of a program	Text on dark, cards
--ink	Near-black	—	Body text on light

Two neutrals + brass + one sparing rose accent. High-contrast pairings only (WCAG AA). The rose is a **spice, not a base** — used for emphasis and focus states, never as a field.

Typography. *Display:* a single **hand-lettered logotype** commissioned from a named Chicano/Mexican letterer (the Smithsonian “re-signification” borrow) — instant, non-clichéd specificity and 29-year gravitas. *Display headings:* a high-contrast serif or a confident grotesk with real character (e.g., a Canela/Reckless-class serif or a GT-class grotesk — license TBD), used large and sparingly. *Body:* a clean, warm sans that renders **diacritics, ñ, ¡ ;** cleanly at small sizes and absorbs ~20–30% Spanish text expansion (e.g., an Inter/Söhne-class face). Set lang correctly per language. Numerals: tabular for prices/stats.

Spanish typography behavior. Same type system; components sized to the **longer** Spanish string so nothing truncates; never bake text into images (breaks translation + ally).

Grid & spacing. 12-col fluid grid, generous margins, an 8-pt spacing scale; editorial asymmetry over centered symmetry; lots of breathing room (premium = restraint).

Image ratios & treatment. Editorial ratios (3:2, 4:5 portraits, 16:9 film, full-bleed heroes). **Film/photography treatment:** one unified grade so the ragged 29-year archive reads as a curated collection — archival frames graded **warmer/grainier**, present-day frames cleaner/more saturated, so scrolling forward in time *feels* like arrival. Documentary, dignity-first imagery (hands on the vihuela, *botonadura* catching light, a singer mid-phrase, the stage at dusk) — never smiling-in-sombreros stock.

Components. - *Buttons:* solid brass/rose primary with strong contrast; clear focus ring; large tap targets ($\geq 44\text{px}$). - *Cards (artist/tier/story):* generous image, restrained type, one CTA; hover lifts subtly. - *Dividers:* a hairline brass rule or a sandstone band — no decorative motifs. - *Navigation:* slim, calm; persistent Español toggle and Give button; sticky ticket bar on mobile. - *Footer:* organized, trust-forward (501(c)(3), EIN, partner, badges). - *Ticket modules:* named tier + price + view thumbnail + honest note + CTA. - *Artist modules:* portrait + short bio + listen link + CTA. - *Scholarship modules:* portrait + pull-quote + destination college; stat lockups with tabular numerals. - *Sponsor modules:* tiered SVG logo grid.

15. Motion system (Phase 11)

Principle: motion has **narrative purpose** or it doesn't ship. Native scroll always; never scroll-jack.

- *Film-led hero:* poster-still-first, muted loop fades in ($\sim 600\text{ms}$), headline fades up after the image lands.
- *Controlled text reveals:* short fade-up/stagger on section entry ($\leq 300\text{ms}$), once per element.
- *Editorial image transitions:* cross-dissolves; subtle parallax ($\sim 10\text{--}20\%$ max) for depth only.
- *Archival→present:* the same-stage old→now crossfade at the emotional peak of the Legacy section; a quiet year-rail advances with scroll.
- *Artist transitions:* tiles stagger in; rolling-reveal state animates when a new confirmed act is added.
- *Scholarship reveals:* portrait fades, stat counts up (only if reduced-motion is off).
- *Countdown states:* calm tick to Aug 8; morphs to day-of wayfinding.
- *Ticket CTA:* sticky bar slides in after hero; never blocks content.
- **Avoid:** constant floating, gratuitous parallax, startup micro-animations, scroll-hijack, autoplay audio, and anything that delays a ticket click.
- **Reduced motion:** prefers-reduced-motion: reduce disables loops, counts, and parallax; content remains fully usable.
- **Mobile motion reduction:** default to poster stills, fewer simultaneous animations, no heavy video autoloading.

16. Technical recommendation (Phase 12)

Recommended stack: Next.js (App Router) on Vercel, statically generated with incremental revalidation, content from a **lightweight headless CMS (Sanity)**, media on Vercel/Next Image + a video host (Mux or Cloudinary), i18n via Next's routing for / (en) and /es.

Why: This is a **content-light, campaign-heavy, seasonal** site with a hard need for speed (mobile-first audience), SEO, structured data, bilingual routing, and **non-developer editability** for the things that change (lineup, dates, sponsors, scholarship stories, news, ticket links). Next.js + Sanity gives fast static pages, an editor-friendly CMS, and clean previews. Vercel gives image optimization, edge delivery, and simple deploys.

- **Static generation** for all marketing pages (fast, cheap, secure); ISR to publish lineup/sponsor updates without a rebuild.
- **Image optimization** via Next Image (AVIF/WebP, responsive); **video** via Mux/Cloudinary with poster stills and adaptive streaming.
- **Analytics:** GA4 + **Meta Pixel** + optional server-side tagging; **Consent Management** (a CMP for GDPR/CCPA) gating pixels.
- **SEO:** per-language metadata, hreflang, XML sitemaps, and **structured data:** Event (with offers, location=Santa Barbara Bowl, startDate 2026-08-08, performer for confirmed acts only), Organization/NGO (with nonprofitStatus), BreadcrumbList, FAQPage.
- **Accessibility & performance:** WCAG 2.1 AA; Core Web Vitals budget (LCP < 2.5s on 4G mobile via poster-first hero).
- **Security:** static surface minimizes attack area; forms via a managed provider (e.g., form endpoint + spam protection); HTTPS + HSTS (fixes the current http canonical).
- **Bilingual routing:** / and /es as first-class trees with reciprocal hreflang, **no IP auto-redirect**, persistent context-aware toggle.

Alternative (lower-cost/faster-to-launch): a **premium Squarespace or Webflow** rebuild. Honest trade-off: Webflow gets ~80% of the visual ambition with a gentler maintenance model and no dev team; it is weaker on true bilingual routing, custom motion, and structured data. **[REC]** If the org has any developer continuity, choose Next.js + Sanity; if it must be fully self-managed by volunteers with zero dev access, choose **Webflow** and accept the ceiling. Do **not** stay on the current untended Squarespace template.

17. CMS recommendation (Phase 12 cont.) & ownership/continuity

What must be editable by a non-developer: artists/lineup, dates/times, ticket links + prices, sponsors (logos + tiers), scholarship stories, news/press, FAQ, and all bilingual copy. **Recommendation:** **Sanity** (or Webflow CMS in the alt path) with clearly-labeled bilingual fields (en/es side-by-side) and a **single source of truth** for shared facts (board, mission, EIN) to prevent the current EN/ES contradictions.

Ownership & continuity plan (so the org isn't hostage to one developer): 1. All code in an **org-owned Git repository**; Vercel + Sanity + domain under **org-owned accounts** (not a vendor's personal login). 2. A short **runbook**: how to edit content, publish, roll back, rotate the ticket link, and update the lineup — written for a volunteer. 3. **Bilingual editorial checklist** baked into the CMS (don't publish EN without ES parity for tickets/dates/board). 4. **Two named admins** on every platform; documented credentials in the org's password manager. 5. A **maintenance SLA / handoff doc** and a lightweight annual "pre-Fiesta refresh" checklist. 6. Prefer **standard tools** (Next/Sanity/Webflow) over bespoke systems so any competent developer can take over.

18. Analytics plan (Phase 12 cont.)

- **GA4** with the event model in §12-CONV; **qualified outbound ticket click** as the primary macro-conversion (checkout is on AXS).
- **Meta Pixel** (+ CAPI server-side if feasible) for retargeting the intent LPs; conversions API reconciled to AXS settlement.
- **Consent Management Platform** gating all marketing tags; analytics-only mode pre-consent where lawful.
- **UTM governance** (§12-CONV) so every AXS link is attributable by channel/artist/tier/LP.
- **Dashboards**: funnel (hero → tier select → ticket click), list growth, donate clicks, cost-per-qualified-click by channel, and a weekly pre-event pacing view.
- **Reconciliation**: monthly match of on-site ticket clicks to AXS reports to estimate true conversion by tier and intent.

19. SEO plan (Phase 12 cont.)

- **Clean, descriptive slugs** replacing /new-page-1, /projects, and the mislabeled /espanol: /tickets, /artists, /scholarships, /legacy, /visit, /es/boletos, /es/becas, etc.
- **Per-language metadata** (title + description) on every page; **hreflang** reciprocal pairs; **canonical over HTTPS** (fixes current http).
- **Structured data**: Event, Organization/NGO, FAQPage, BreadcrumbList (confirmed facts only).
- **Correct Open Graph/Twitter cards per language** so shares render right in each language (the current single OG image breaks Spanish shares).
- **Real alt text** on every image (kills filename alt text); no text baked into images.
- **Target queries**: "Santa Barbara Mariachi Festival," "Santa Barbara Bowl mariachi 2026," "[confirmed artist] Santa Barbara," "cosas que hacer en Fiesta Santa Barbara," plus scholarship/donor terms.
- **Performance as SEO**: Core Web Vitals budget; image/video optimization.

20. Accessibility plan (Phase 12 cont.) — WCAG 2.1 AA target

- **Contrast** AA for all text (the palette is chosen to pass); visible focus states; ≥44px tap targets.
- **Keyboard** operability for nav, seat cards, toggles, and the sticky CTA; logical focus order; skip-to-content.
- **Screen readers:** semantic landmarks, real alt text, lang per language, ARIA only where needed; the seat map has a text-equivalent tier table (already the primary UI).
- **Motion:** honor prefers-reduced-motion; no autoplay audio; no motion-only information.
- **Media:** captions/transcripts for testimonial video; poster stills.
- **Forms:** labeled fields, error text, no CAPTCHA that blocks; inline validation.
- **No image-baked text** (fixes sponsor/sponsorship screenshots — an all y and bilingual fix).
- **Process:** automated (axe) + manual keyboard/SR passes pre-launch; the design:accessibility-review skill can run the formal audit at handoff.

21. Bilingual UX plan (Phase 12 cont.)

- **Two first-class trees:** / (en) and /es with hand-localized slugs; **transcreated** copy authored by a native Mexican-Spanish writer (not machine-translated).
- **Persistent, context-aware “Español/English” toggle** on every page that lands on the *equivalent* page and remembers the choice; labeled with the word, never a flag; **no IP auto-redirect**.
- **Full parity, including tickets and giving** — the current site’s fatal gap (no Spanish ticket path) is closed.
- **Localized creative:** separate ES poster/CTA art where text appears; “**Compra tus boletos.**”
- **Single source of truth** for shared facts to end EN/ES contradictions (board, years, event data).
- **Bilingual glossary/style guide** (tú vs. usted decision; terms left in Spanish: *el mariachi*, *el grito*, *boletos*, *becas*, song/artist names).
- **Watch the checkout handoff:** AXS may revert to English — flag to users and, if possible, deep-link to any Spanish AXS surface.
- **QA:** a bilingual reviewer signs off nav, footer, forms, error states, and meta/OG per language before launch.

22. Content & asset inventory (Phase 14)

AVAILABLE NOW (verified public facts/text). All facts in §2–§4: dates, times, venue, prices, org data, mission, board (EN), sponsor names, scholarship model, 2024/2025 recipient names + colleges, press quotes/links, social handles.

PUBLICLY VISIBLE — RIGHTS MUST BE CONFIRMED. The 2025 festival photo set (**RG Photography** — confirm license); homepage/archive images on Squarespace; Noozhawk Fiesta images (**Fritz Olenberger / Old Spanish Days** — separate rights); any artist portraits/logos; press-outlet logos (editorial use).

MISSING (needed, not yet in hand). Confirmed 2026 lineup + billing; reconciled cumulative scholarship figure + per-year data; recipient consent + quotes/portraits for storytelling; alumni “where are they now”; clean SVG sponsor logos + tier structure; sponsorship package as real content (not screenshots); seat-view media per terrace; a proper hero film + poster.

NEEDS CLIENT ACCESS. Full 990 Schedule I (scholarship line items); recipient/alumni contact + releases; sponsor package details; official artist assets; live social metrics; org-owned domain/CMS/analytics accounts; brand assets/logo history.

NEEDS NEW PRODUCTION. See shot list (\$23).

23. Missing-asset production shot list (Phase 14)

A single golden-hour + show-night shoot at the 2026 festival (plus a scholarship-reception shoot) covers most gaps. Priorities:

- **Hero film (P0):** the Bowl stage at golden hour; a mariachi mid-phrase; the sandstone wall glowing; a slow push-in — muted, poster-friendly, 15–30s loop + a longer cut.
- **Artist footage (P0):** each **confirmed** act performing; clean portraits; *botonadura*/trumpet-bell/vihuela detail.
- **Crowd footage (P1):** the *grito* moment, families singing along, three generations in a row, the crowd eruption — with **signage/consent** for identifiable minors.
- **Venue exterior/interior (P1):** entrance/gates, the terraces, the sunset backdrop; **one seat-view still per terrace** (for the seat guide).
- **Sunset (P1):** the specific golden-hour light the palette is built on.
- **Families / food (P1):** arrival, shared meals, multigenerational moments (consented).
- **Backstage / quiet details (P1):** tuning, tailoring, the breath before the trumpet, hands and hats — the “premium restraint” imagery.
- **Instruments & charro details (P1):** macro detail for texture/dividers.
- **Student musicians / scholarship recipients (P0 for mission):** recipients in traje performing on the Bowl stage; documentary portraits; **short testimonial video** (30–60s, opportunity-framed) — with **consent/releases**.
- **Sponsor moments (P2):** activations, the VIP party (with permission).
- **Vertical social footage (P0 for paid):** 9:16 cuts of all of the above for Meta/Reels retargeting.
- **Seat-view footage (P1):** enable AXS FanSight and/or shoot representative views.

Interim for the concept prototype: use only rights-cleared or clearly-labeled placeholder imagery, with sources documented and a “rights to confirm” flag (see §25 and the prototype note).

24. Risk register (Phase 15)

#	Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation
1	Building around unconfirmed lineup (Majo Aguilar/Joss Favela)	Med	High	Confirmed-acts-only rule; lineup as CMS variable; rolling reveal
2	Publishing a wrong scholarship total (\$1M vs \$650K)	Med	High	Reconcile with org before printing; use range/qualitative if unresolved
3	Photo rights (RG Photography / Olenberger) not cleared	High	High	Confirm licenses; produce owned assets; placeholders flagged in concept
4	Recipient privacy / minors' images	Med	High	Written consent/releases; asset-framing; opt-in only
5	AXS adds fees/dynamic pricing contradicting posted prices	Med	Med	All-in messaging; “plus AXS fees”; verify before campaign
6	Fake-scarcity temptation to move inventory	Med	High	Honesty rules in §12; only real signals
7	Bilingual drift returns post-launch	Med	Med	Single source of truth + CMS parity checklist
8	Volunteer maintenance	High	Med	Webflow-or-documented-

	lapses			Next path; runbook; two admins
9	Vendor lock-in / bus factor	Med	Med	Org-owned repo/accounts; standard tools; handoff doc
10	Deficit budget limits scope	Med	Med	Phased roadmap; ship conversion fixes first (cheapest, highest ROB)
11	Concept mistaken for authorized work	Low	High	Persistent “internal, unauthorized concept” labeling; no live deploy
12	Consent/ privacy compliance for pixels	Med	Med	CMP gating; privacy policy; analytics-only pre-consent

25. Implementation roadmap (Phase 15)

Phase 0 — Confirm (client, ~1–2 wks). Lock lineup, reconcile scholarship figures, clear photo rights, confirm on-sale/pricing mechanics, choose stack (Next+Sanity vs Webflow), secure org-owned accounts, decide Spanish voice + reviewer. *Gate: nothing ships without these.*

Phase 1 — Conversion triage (fast, high-ROI; can precede full rebuild). Replace the shortened ticket link with a branded, tracked AXS deep link; add a sticky mobile CTA and ticket links site-wide; fix the transposed email, stale footers/years, and the EN/ES board contradiction; stand up a **Spanish ticket path**. *These are the cheapest, highest-value fixes and reduce risk immediately even on the current platform.*

Phase 2 — Design system + build. Commission the hand-lettered logotype; finalize palette/type/motion; build the Next.js/Sanity (or Webflow) site with the IA in \$9; wire GA4/Pixel/consent, schema, hreflang, clean slugs; migrate real content with bilingual parity.

Phase 3 — Content production. Execute the shot list; produce hero film, artist/seat-view media, recipient stories + video (with consent); clean SVG sponsor logos; real sponsorship package + inquiry form; press kit.

Phase 4 — Campaign layer. Intent LPs (\$13), rolling lineup reveal, email/SMS capture, retargeting audiences, honest urgency/countdown, day-of wayfinding.

Phase 5 — Launch + QA. Accessibility audit (WCAG 2.1 AA), bilingual QA, performance/Core Web Vitals, analytics validation, cross-device, security (HTTPS/HSTS). Soft launch → announce.

Phase 6 — Steady state / handoff. Runbook, two admins per platform, annual pre-Fiesta refresh checklist, post-event analytics reconciliation, and a “lessons learned → next year” loop.

Sequencing logic: Phase 1 pays for itself before the rebuild lands; Phases 2–4 build the durable platform; Phases 5–6 protect quality and the org’s independence. Given the FY2024 deficit, this order deliberately front-loads the revenue-protecting fixes.